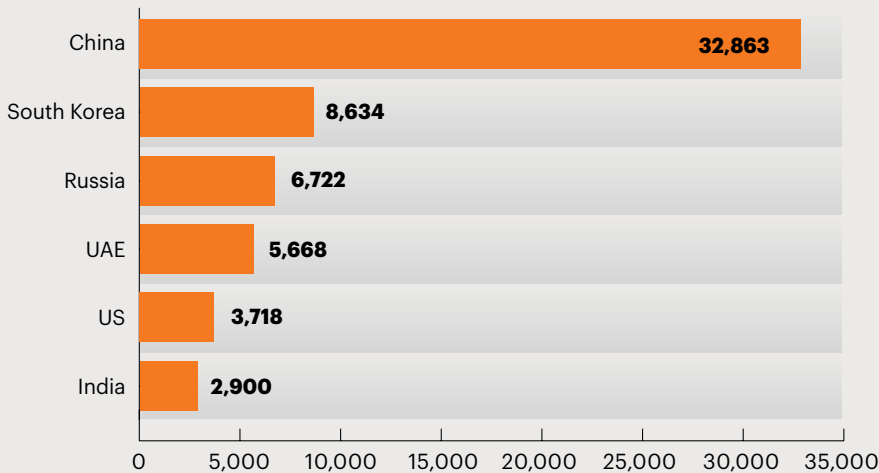


A GLOBAL ASSESSMENT

- India ranks sixth in nuclear capacity addition
- China has added the most capacity and will continue to be the top player



NOTE NUCLEAR CAPACITY IN MW; BETWEEN 2015 AND 2024

SOURCE GLOBAL ENERGY MONITOR



“In India, the model where you set up the asset, own it, and then transfer it, is unlikely”

VIVEK JAIN
DIRECTOR, INDIA
RATINGS & RESEARCH

O&M players to choose from,” he says.

Jain has a different take. He wants gradual progression from 220 MW to 700 MW for private players. “The initial set-up in India was 220 MW. Gradually, we progressed to 500 MW and then to 700 MW. I think progression for the private players will be similar. So, you start with a lower scale, get hands-on experience and then build at a higher scale,” he says.

On tie-ups with foreign players, a lot will depend on the changing geopolitical situation. Russia, France and the US have offered India expertise in building small modular reactors. Domestic players are already getting ready for the possible boom. CORE Energy Systems Ltd, a Mumbai-based engineering firm, has raised ₹200

crore in a fresh funding round to accelerate its expertise in precision nuclear engineering. Nagesh Basarkar, Managing Director, says for global companies, it offers a strategic entry into one of the world’s fastest-growing nuclear markets, leveraging technology transfer, joint ventures with locally well-established companies and co-development models to indigenise critical technology at scale.

“The expansion will also drive the rise of a new industrial and MSME ecosystem, while generating high-quality employment and advancing nuclear education, training, and certification,” says Basarkar. The company is about to complete the refurbishment of India’s oldest nuclear facility at Tarapur, commissioned in 1969.

THE WAY FORWARD

India’s nuclear plans centre on advancement of indigenous fast breeder reactors, BSRs tailored for decarbonising hard-to-abate industrial sectors, and small modular reactors of varying capacities. These are essential for ensuring cleaner energy in smaller grids and potential export to partner nations.

Private players are looking to scale up nuclear power capacity in the country at a fast pace provided the legal and procedural issues are addressed. They are looking to get started by the end of the year but obtaining secure financing, acquiring land for the plants, and getting regulatory clearances to start their nuclear journey will take a lot of time and effort. **BT**

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